

Tenure of housing units

Table 11.4 : Tenure of Housing Units by Sector and District, 2024

Sector/ District	Total	Tenure of housing units					
		Owned by a household member	Rent/lease-Government owned	Rent/lease-privately owned	Free of Rent	Encroached	Other
Sri Lanka	100.0	84.6	2.0	6.4	5.4	0.7	0.9
Sector							
Urban	100.0	77.1	3.6	14.6	3.1	1.0	0.6
Estate- Urban	100.0	39.1	1.8	5.6	45.1	4.2	4.2
Rural	100.0	89.0	1.6	4.7	3.2	0.6	0.9
Estate- Rural	100.0	29.5	4.4	4.2	58.3	0.7	2.9
District							
Colombo	100.0	76.0	3.5	16.6	2.4	1.0	0.5
Gampaha	100.0	81.6	2.2	12.5	2.2	0.8	0.7
Kalutara	100.0	86.8	1.9	5.9	4.1	0.5	0.8
Kandy	100.0	84.6	3.0	5.3	5.0	0.7	1.4
Matale	100.0	86.7	1.7	3.8	5.9	0.7	1.2
Nuwara Eliya	100.0	52.2	2.1	4.4	39.8	0.7	0.8
Galle	100.0	89.5	1.4	4.1	3.2	0.5	1.3
Matara	100.0	88.8	1.5	3.7	4.0	0.4	1.6
Hambantota	100.0	93.3	1.3	2.2	1.5	0.8	0.9
Jaffna	100.0	74.4	2.1	8.7	13.8	0.3	0.7
Mannar	100.0	87.0	1.6	4.7	6.1	0.1	0.5
Vavuniya	100.0	83.5	2.5	7.2	6.0	0.4	0.4
Mullaitivu	100.0	89.4	1.5	3.0	5.4	0.4	0.3
Kilinochchi	100.0	89.0	1.2	3.6	5.4	0.3	0.5
Batticaloa	100.0	87.7	1.5	3.5	6.6	0.1	0.6
Ampara	100.0	90.9	1.2	2.7	4.3	0.6	0.3
Trincomalee	100.0	88.7	2.2	3.7	4.5	0.4	0.5
Kurunegala	100.0	91.2	1.1	3.1	2.7	0.6	1.3
Puttalam	100.0	87.2	1.4	5.2	4.6	0.7	0.9
Anuradhapura	100.0	91.5	1.9	2.5	2.5	0.9	0.7
Polonnaruwa	100.0	93.3	1.6	1.9	1.2	1.3	0.7
Badulla	100.0	80.5	2.4	3.9	10.8	1.0	1.4
Moneragala	100.0	91.5	1.4	1.9	2.7	1.6	0.9
Ratnapura	100.0	85.5	2.3	4.0	5.7	1.3	1.2
Kegalle	100.0	86.9	2.1	3.9	5.1	0.3	1.7

The information regarding the nature of tenure of housing units was collected and categorized into six groups as indicated in the Table 11.4 above. According to the data collected, the majority of housing units fall under the category 'Owned by a household member,' accounting for 84.6 percent. The highest percentage of housing units 'Owned by a household member' is reported in the Hambantota and Polonnaruwa districts each (93.3%). Furthermore, the highest percentage of housing units categorized as 'Rented/Leased from the private sector' is reported in the Colombo district (16.6%), followed by the Gampaha district at 12.5 percent. In addition, encroached housing units account for 0.7 percent of the total housing units reported in Sri Lanka. The 'Rent-free' category includes units such as estate housing or houses owned by family member or others for which no rent is paid; 5.4 percent of total housing units are reported as 'Rent-free'.